Training-free mean-field adjoint manifold initialization for constrained variational quantum optimization

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Constrained combinatorial optimization with the Quantum Approximate Optimization Algorithm (QAOA) must navigate rugged landscapes induced by competing local fields and quadratic spin couplings. Homogeneous annealing ramps apply uniform phases across qubits and require dozens of noisy online measurements for selection, whereas warm-start schemes alter the circuit ansatz and forfeit native global-pulse execution. Here we prove that within the unmodified depth-$2k$ global QAOA circuit, anti-symmetric cost pairing with odd-layer spin flips achieves $2k$-dimensional parity cancellation of quadratic couplings, establishing an exact quantum-classical product-energy identity. Exploiting this identity, we introduce `Echo-MF-2kD`, a training-free initializer integrating temperature-continuation mean-field orientation, Daubechies maximally flat anchors, and $O(kn)$ SU(2)-adjoint refinement. Across 1,024 Maximum Weight Independent Set instances at $n = 10$ and 5,120 cross-scale instances spanning $n = 6$–14, `Echo-MF-2kD` requires zero Stage-1 measurements, doubles Trotterized Quantum Annealing ground-state probability (46.16% versus 22.42% at $n = 10$), cuts Stage-2 quantum calls by 45.2%, and achieves 100% shot-noise selection immunity.

Introduction

Constrained combinatorial optimization problems—such as Maximum Weight Independent Set (MWIS)—arise across network allocation and statistical physics, mapping to Ising Hamiltonians $H_C = H_J + H_h + C$ over n spins $s \in \{-1, +1\}^n$ [1–3]. Under hard-constraint penalties, heterogeneous vertex degrees induce strong site-specific local fields $H_h = \sum_i h_i S_i$ competing with repulsive quadratic couplings $H_J = \sum_{i<j} J_{ij} S_i S_j$ [4]. The Quantum Approximate Optimization Algorithm (QAOA) prepares a p-layer state $|\psi_p(\vartheta)\rangle = \prod_{\ell=1}^{p} U_B(\beta_\ell) U_C(\gamma_\ell) |+\rangle^{\otimes n}$ via cost unitaries $U_C(\gamma_\ell) = e^{-i\gamma_\ell H_C}$ and global transverse-field mixers $U_B(\beta_\ell) = e^{-i\beta_\ell \sum_i X_i}$ [5–8]. Preserving $|+\rangle^{\otimes n}$ and global mixers $U_B(\beta_\ell)$ is vital for superconducting processors [9], trapped-ion simulators [10], and Rydberg atom arrays [3], where a single global pulse drives all qubits natively. At fixed depth p, however, the non-convex $2p$-dimensional energy landscape contains exponentially many suboptimal minima and symmetric branches [11–17]. Because each parameter-shift gradient step requires $O(p)$ circuit executions and thousands of measurement shots [18,19], computing a high-overlap starting point $\vartheta_0 \in \mathbb{R}^{2p}$ solely from (J, h) without circuit modification or online selection measurements is a central challenge.

Existing QAOA initializers face fundamental trade-offs under heterogeneous local fields. First, homogeneous schedules—including Trotterized Quantum Annealing (TQA) [20–24], layerwise interpolation (INTERP) [25,26], and parameter transfer [27–29]—apply identical phase ramps across all qubits and cannot resolve site-specific spin orientations on conflicting edges [30]; moreover, online TQA requires dozens of Stage-1 quantum evaluations vulnerable to shot-noise misselection ("Winner's Curse"). Second, ansatz-modifying schemes such as Semidefinite-Programming (SDP) Warm-Start QAOA [31–33] and multi-angle `ma-QAOA` [34] either replace uniform mixers with custom rotations that forfeit global-pulse compatibility and induce spin-freezing dead zones, or inflate parameter dimension to $O(p(|V| + |E|))$ at prohibitive measurement cost. Third, spin-echo parity decoupling within the standard global circuit [35–39] pairs anti-symmetric cost angles $(-g_j, g_j)$ with odd-layer flips $\beta_{2j-1} = \pi/2$ to cancel H_J along a one-dimensional (1D) scalar ray $g_j = a r_j$ [39–43]. Without offline supervision, however, restricting all k pairs to one scalar a encounters two barriers when $n > 2k$: (1) *Diophantine frequency crowding*, where one scalar cannot align $n > 2k$ incommensurate frequencies $4h_i$; and (2) *local effective-field inversion*, where weakly polarized qubits suffer repulsive pulls $(J\boldsymbol{m})_i$ upon Stage-2 coupling reactivation, flipping their local effective field $h_i^{\text{eff}}(\boldsymbol{m}) = h_i + (J\boldsymbol{m})_i$.

To overcome both barriers without circuit modification or quantum measurements, we observe that parity cancellation of H_J is an intra-pair algebraic identity rather than a 1D property. Because each spin-echo pair conjugates H_C by the global flip operator $F = \prod_{i=1}^{n} X_i$ independently, exact cancellation of H_J holds across the entire $2k$-dimensional complete-pair submanifold where all k cost half-angles $\boldsymbol{g} \in \mathbb{R}^k$ and k even-layer mixer angles $\boldsymbol{\theta} \in \mathbb{R}^k$ vary freely. On this $2k$-dimensional manifold, the $2p$-layer state factorizes strictly into single-qubit states computable in $O(kn)$ classical 2×2 operations, and inter-qubit independence guarantees that the multi-body quantum expected energy equals the classical product-state energy identically: $\langle\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})|H_C|\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})\rangle \equiv$

$E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$. This identity reduces quantum initialization to a differentiable classical control problem on $\mathrm{SU}(2)^{\otimes n}$ that anticipates multi-body coupling effects via E_{prod} and $h_i^{\text{eff}}(\boldsymbol{m})$ before any quantum circuit runs.

Here we introduce Mean-Field Multi-Scalar Adjoint Product-Manifold Initialization (`Echo-MF-2kD`), a training-free, zero-quantum-selection framework mapping (J, h) directly to standard $2p$-dimensional global QAOA angles. For non-vanishing local fields ($h_i \neq 0$) at positive even depth $p = 2k$, we prove that the $2k$-dimensional complete-pair submanifold preserves exact product factorization and product-energy equivalence while guaranteeing first-order linear reactivation of H_J under symmetry-breaking Stage-2 perturbations. Algorithmically, `Echo-MF-2kD` resolves edge repulsion into a self-consistent binary orientation $\hat{\boldsymbol{s}} \in \{-1, +1\}^n$ via damped mean-field temperature continuation and single-edge cluster flips, extracts resonance anchors using the strict convexity of 1D Daubechies responses on zero-free intervals, and performs staged $O(kn)$ reverse-mode SU(2)-adjoint refinement within a non-degenerate mixer domain to optimize flip-sensitivity-weighted log-likelihood, local effective-field inversion guards, and E_{prod}, followed by Stage-2 full-angle recoupling[44]. Across 1,024 held-out MWIS instances at $n = 10$, 5,120 cross-scale instances ($n \in \{6, 8, 10, 12, 14\}$), and 2,750 five-family benchmark instances, `Echo-MF-2kD` doubles online TQA ground-state probability at $n = 10$ (46.16% versus 22.42%, reaching 60.80% at $p = 12$) with zero Stage-1 measurements, 45.2% fewer Stage-2 quantum calls, and 100% Stage-1 shot-noise immunity.

Results

Exact product-energy identity on the $2k$-dimensional spin-echo manifold



Figure 1. Algorithmic architecture and physical mechanism of `Echo-MF-2kD`. Given an unseen problem instance (J, h), Stage 1 operates entirely on a classical processor with zero online quantum evaluations: damped mean-field temperature continuation and single-edge cluster flips first lock onto a self-consistent binary target orientation $\hat{\boldsymbol{s}} \in \{-1, +1\}^n$; 1D Daubechies maximally flat convex-interval root extraction then identifies resonance anchors $(\boldsymbol{g}^{(0)}, \boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)})$; finally, staged $O(kn)$ reverse-mode SU(2)-adjoint optimization refines all $2k$ intra-pair parameters on the complete spin-echo product manifold under non-degenerate mixer bounds, local effective-field inversion guards, and the exact classical product energy E_{prod} to produce standard $2p$-dimensional global QAOA angles ϑ_0. Stage 2 releases all $2p$ angles in a standard L-BFGS-B quantum energy optimizer, breaking pair anti-symmetry to activate multi-body entanglement and converge rapidly to the true ground state $s^\star$.

In a standard global QAOA circuit of positive even depth $p = 2k$, pairing adjacent layers $2j - 1$ and $2j$ ($j = 1, \ldots, k$) with anti-symmetric cost angles $(\gamma_{2j-1}, \gamma_{2j}) = (-g_j, g_j)$ and mixer angles $(\beta_{2j-1}, \beta_{2j}) = (\pi/2, \theta_j)$ sets every odd-layer mixer equal to the global spin-flip operator $U_B(\pi/2) = (-i)^n F$, where $F = \prod_{i=1}^n X_i$. Because quadratic spin-spin couplings are even under global spin inversion ($FH_JF = H_J$) whereas local external fields are

odd ($FH_hF = -H_h$), the composite unitary of the j-th pair simplifies identically to $E(g_j, \theta_j) = U_B(\theta_j)e^{-2ig_j H_h}F$ up to a global phase[39] (Methods). Crucially, this operator cancellation occurs *within each pair individually* and imposes no cross-pair ratio constraints on (g_j, θ_j). Consequently, across the entire $2k$-dimensional complete-pair parameter submanifold $(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = (g_1, \ldots, g_k, \theta_1, \ldots, \theta_k) \in [-10\pi, 10\pi]^k \times [-\pi/2, \pi/2)^k$, the $2p$-layer quantum circuit output factorizes strictly into a tensor product of single-qubit states $|\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})\rangle = \bigotimes_{i=1}^{n} u_i^{(k)}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$, whose positive-spin probabilities $p_i^+(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = |u_{i,+}^{(k)}|^2$ and magnetizations $m_i(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = 2p_i^+ - 1 \in [-1, 1]$ are evaluated deterministically in $O(kn)$ time via k steps of 2×2 unitary recursion. Because Pauli-Z observables on distinct qubits are statistically independent in any product state ($\langle Z_i Z_j \rangle = m_i m_j$ for $i \neq j$), the multi-body quantum expected energy on the $2k$-dimensional submanifold equals the classical product-state energy identically:

$$\langle \psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) | H_C | \psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) \rangle \equiv E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{2} \boldsymbol{m}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})^\top J \boldsymbol{m}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) + \boldsymbol{h}^\top \boldsymbol{m}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) + C.$$

Furthermore, perturbing the j-th pair's cost angles along the symmetry-breaking coordinate $(-g_j + \delta_j, g_j + \delta_j)$ in Stage 2 yields the pair operator $U_B(\theta_j)e^{-2i\delta_j H_J}e^{-2ig_j H_h}F$, which re-activates quadratic coupling evolution H_J linearly to first order in δ_j and guarantees non-vanishing tangent gradients upon departing the product manifold (Methods).

This exact quantum–classical correspondence enables classical optimization of $E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$ and single-qubit phase alignment across all $2k$ degrees of freedom with zero quantum circuit executions (Figure 1). Our framework (`Echo-MF-2kD` in online training-free mode; `Echo-Flat-2kD` in offline known-target analysis) comprises three mechanistic stages detailed in Methods: (1) *deterministic temperature-continuation cluster orientation*, which continues damped mean-field magnetizations across an ascending inverse-temperature schedule with zero-temperature single-edge cluster swaps to resolve soft-marginal ambiguity into a self-consistent binary orientation $\hat{\boldsymbol{s}} \in \{-1, +1\}^n$; (2) *Daubechies maximally flat convex-interval anchor extraction*, which exploits the strict convexity of 1D Daubechies negative log-likelihood on zero-free intervals to extract resonance anchors $(\boldsymbol{g}^{(0)}, \boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)})$ via bisection; and (3) *staged* $O(kn)$ *reverse-mode* SU(2)*-adjoint refinement*, which backpropagates analytical gradients through the k-step 2×2 spinor recursion (Step 1a aligning k cost angles $\boldsymbol{g}$, Step 1b jointly refining $(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$ within a non-degenerate mixer bound $|\theta_j| \leq \theta_{\max} < \pi/2$) to optimize flip-sensitivity-weighted log-likelihood, local effective-field inversion guards, and E_{prod}.

Table 1. Progressive component ablation from 1D scalar scanning to guarded staged $2k$D manifold refinement on unseen MWIS test sets. Values report mean initial → post-optimization ground-state probabilities $P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{init}} \to P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{final}}$ (%) with 4,000-resample bootstrap 95% confidence intervals (CIs) and Stage-1 all-qubit quadrant hit rates ($\forall i : h_i \neq 0, \pi_i > 0.50$, in parentheses) across $n \in \{8, 10, 12\}$ at fixed depth $p = 10$ ($k = 5$ pairs; 1,024 unseen test instances per scale). Both offline known-target mode (`Echo-Flat-*`) and online training-free mode (`Echo-MF-*`, taking only (J, h) with zero online quantum selection evaluations) are evaluated under identical Stage-2 L-BFGS-B settings. Bold values denote the best final ground-state probability within each mode.

Mode & Ablation Variant	Active Degrees of Freedom & Adjoint Physical Guards	$n = 8$ ($P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{init}} \to P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{final}}$, Quad. Hit)	$n = 10$ ($P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{init}} \to P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{final}}$, Quad. Hit)	$n = 12$ ($P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{init}} \to P_{\text{gs}}^{\text{final}}$, Quad. Hit)
Offline `Echo-Flat-1D`	1-D scalar a, Flat-Top convex-interval bisection	$33.19 \to 77.25^{+1.36}_{-1.34}$% (46.0%)	$13.07 \to 53.08^{+1.51}_{-1.57}$% (18.8%)	$3.69 \to 29.64^{+1.33}_{-1.25}$% (4.4%)
Offline `Echo-Flat-kD (Cost-Only)`	k-D cost $\boldsymbol{g}$, fixed $\boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)}$, unweighted unguarded NLL	$35.02 \to 78.47^{+1.19}_{-1.23}$% (69.0%)	$15.17 \to 55.73^{+1.37}_{-1.38}$% (37.7%)	$4.91 \to 33.63^{+1.22}_{-1.14}$% (17.3%)
Offline `Echo-Flat-kD (Guarded)`	k-D cost $\boldsymbol{g}$, weighted inversion guard + $\alpha_E E_{\text{prod}}$	$33.05 \to 78.35^{+1.21}_{-1.24}$% (49.3%)	$13.66 \to 54.79^{+1.47}_{-1.49}$% (22.7%)	$4.09 \to 32.50^{+1.19}_{-1.22}$% (6.5%)
Offline `Echo-Flat-2kD (Unconstrained)`	$2k$-D full pair $(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$, unguarded unstaged	$71.52 \to 84.53^{+0.94}_{-0.95}$% (94.4%)	$45.45 \to 64.03^{+1.20}_{-1.25}$% (88.8%)	$23.40 \to 41.36^{+1.19}_{-1.19}$% (77.8%)
Offline `Echo-Flat-2kD`	$2k$-D staged refinement, non-degenerate mixer + inversion guard + E_{prod}	$70.89 \to \mathbf{85.01}^{+0.92}_{-0.93}$% (94.0%)	$44.31 \to \mathbf{64.29}^{+1.22}_{-1.24}$% (86.4%)	$22.87 \to \mathbf{41.41}^{+1.18}_{-1.15}$% (75.0%)
Online Training-Free `Echo-MF-Flat (Echo-MF-1D)`	Mean-field soft marginals + 1-D overlap decoding	$15.96 \to 45.11^{+2.41}_{-2.40}$% (0.0%)	$5.39 \to 23.23^{+1.83}_{-1.92}$% (0.0%)	$1.26 \to 9.74^{+1.21}_{-1.12}$% (0.0%)
Online Training-Free `Echo-MF-kD (Soft, Cost-Only)`	Mean-field soft marginals + unguarded k-D cost refinement	$21.08 \to 46.96^{+2.36}_{-2.35}$% (73.2%)	$8.16 \to 23.83^{+1.82}_{-1.77}$% (39.6%)	$2.51 \to 9.65^{+1.08}_{-1.04}$% (22.0%)
Online Training-Free `Echo-MF-kD (Guarded)`	Temp.-continuation cluster orientation + guarded k-D cost	$32.47 \to 61.64^{+2.17}_{-2.26}$% (49.2%)	$13.03 \to 31.58^{+1.99}_{-1.96}$% (22.5%)	$3.89 \to 12.31^{+1.27}_{-1.26}$% (6.3%)
Online Training-Free `Echo-MF-2kD (Unconstrained)`	Temp.-continuation cluster orientation + unguarded $2k$-D	$70.03 \to 74.69^{+1.64}_{-1.69}$% (94.3%)	$43.20 \to \mathbf{46.75}^{+1.77}_{-1.85}$% (88.8%)	$21.88 \to 22.39^{+1.30}_{-1.35}$% (77.9%)
Online Training-Free `Echo-MF-2kD`	Temp.-continuation cluster orientation + guarded staged $2k$-D	$69.41 \to \mathbf{74.99}^{+1.65}_{-1.68}$% (93.8%)	$42.20 \to 46.70^{+1.78}_{-1.90}$% (86.8%)	$21.38 \to \mathbf{22.64}^{+1.31}_{-1.38}$% (75.0%)

Controlled ablations across 5,120 unseen MWIS instances confirm the distinct physical role of each mechanism (Table 1). First, in online unsupervised mode, fitting unoriented soft mean-field marginals (`Echo-MF-kD (Soft, Cost-Only)`) stalls at 23.83% ($n = 10$) and 9.65% ($n = 12$) because frustrated vertices with $\pi_i^{\text{mf}} \approx 0.5$ pull optimization toward incompatible independent-set branches. Introducing deterministic temperature-continuation cluster orientation and effective-field inversion guards (`Echo-MF-kD (Guarded)`) lifts single-qubit spin orientation accuracy from 85.03%–89.18% to 93.75%–99.61% and raises online final probabilities by +14.68 and +7.75 percentage points (pp) at $n = 8, 10$. Second, when system size exceeds the pair count ($n \geq 10 > k = 5$), tuning only the $k = 5$ cost angles with frozen 1D Daubechies mixers (`Echo-Flat-kD` and `Echo-MF-kD`) cannot resolve Diophantine frequency crowding, limiting $n = 12$ initial product probabilities to 3.89%–4.91% and all-qubit quadrant hit rates to 6.3%–17.3%. Releasing all $2k = 10$ parameters in Step 1b (`Echo-Flat-2kD` and `Echo-MF-2kD`) boosts the $n = 12$ initial product probability more than fivefold to 21.38%–22.87% and lifts the quadrant hit rate to 75.0% (86.4%–86.8% at $n = 10$). Third, enforcing the non-degenerate mixer bound and staged inversion guards yields the highest cross-scale performance (`Echo-Flat-2kD` reaching $\mathbf{85.01}\%, \mathbf{64.29}\%, \mathbf{41.41}\%$ at $n = 8, 10, 12$; online `Echo-MF-2kD` reaching $\mathbf{94.02}\%, \mathbf{74.99}\%, \mathbf{46.70}\%, \mathbf{22.64}\%, \mathbf{10.13}\%$ across $n = 6$–14), outperforming 1D

`Echo-MF-Flat` by +5.81–+29.88 pp while cutting Stage-2 quantum gradient evaluations from 102.3–122.5 down to **61.3–79.3**.

Doubling ground-state probability while halving quantum search cost

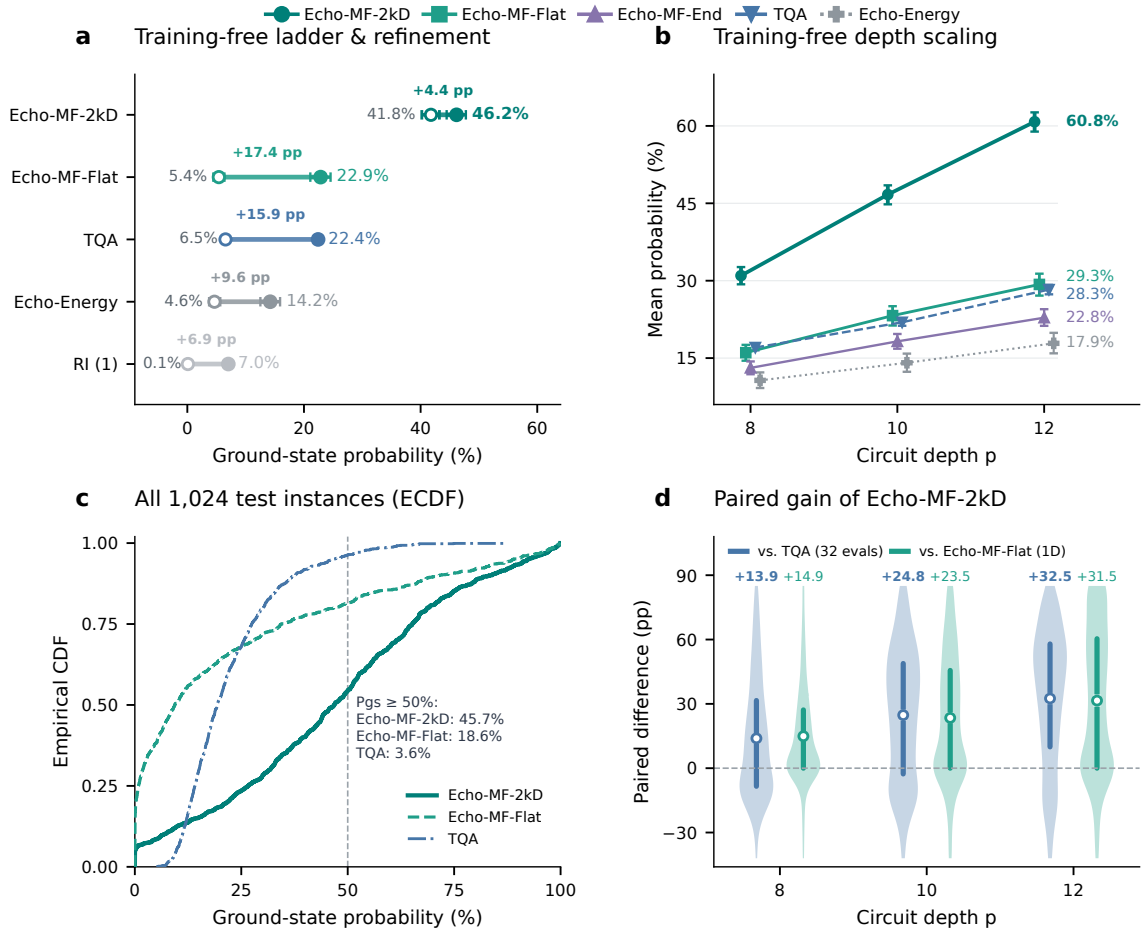


Figure 2. `Echo-MF-2kD` more than doubles the final ground-state probability of online TQA while halving Stage-2 quantum gradient calls on held-out MWIS instances ($n = 10$, 1,024 unseen test instances). a, Cross-depth instance-averaged Stage-1 initial product-state ground-state probability $P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)}$ and Stage-2 post-optimization final ground-state probability P_{gs} across $p \in \{8, 10, 12\}$. **b**, Final mean ground-state probability scaling as a function of circuit depth $p = 8, 10, 12$; error bars denote 4,000-resample non-parametric percentile bootstrap 95% CIs. **c**, Empirical cumulative distribution functions (ECDFs) of cross-depth mean final ground-state probability across all 1,024 test instances, highlighting high-probability instance coverage ($P_{\mathrm{gs}} \geq 50\%$). **d**, Per-instance paired net probability gains (ΔP_{gs}, in percentage points) of `Echo-MF-2kD` over 32-evaluation online TQA and 1D `Echo-MF-Flat` across circuit depths.

Table 2. Stage-wise quantum evaluation cost and initial-to-final ground-state probabilities on the held-out MWIS center test set ($n = 10$, 1,024 unseen instances). All methods receive only (J, h) with zero training data and execute identical Stage-2 full-angle L-BFGS-B energy optimization. Values report Stage-1 online quantum circuit evaluations, Stage-2 gradient quantum evaluations at $p = 8/10/12$ (and cross-depth mean), initial → final mean ground-state probabilities (%) with 4,000-resample bootstrap 95% CIs, and paired net differences relative to 32-evaluation online TQA. Bold indicates the best performance in each column.

Method Name	Prior Source & Initialization Mechanism (Input J, h Only, 0 Training Data)	Stage-1 Online Quantum Evals	Stage-2 Gradient Quantum Evals ($p = 8/10/12$, Mean)	$p = 8$ ($P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)} \to P_{\mathrm{gs}}$)	$p = 10$ ($P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)} \to P_{\mathrm{gs}}$)	$p = 12$ ($P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)} \to P_{\mathrm{gs}}$)	Cross-Depth Mean $P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)} \to P_{\mathrm{gs}}$	Cross-Depth Paired Gain vs. TQA (pp)
RI (1)	Prior-free, single-start random initialization	0	110.1/130.4/135.1 (125.2)	$0.10 \to 3.84^{+0.60}_{-0.57}$	$0.10 \to 6.82^{+0.90}_{-0.87}$	$0.10 \to 10.42^{+1.23}_{-1.20}$	$0.10 \to 7.03\%$	-15.39 ($[-16.18, -14.65]$)
RI (32)	Prior-free, 32-candidate random angles with quantum energy selection	32	123.8/136.9/141.2 (134.0)	$0.22 \to 6.47^{+0.62}_{-0.60}$	$0.20 \to 9.93^{+0.87}_{-0.81}$	$0.17 \to 12.81^{+1.02}_{-0.97}$	$0.20 \to 9.73\%$	-12.69 ($[-13.41, -11.98]$)
Echo-Energy	Prior-free, 1D Flat-Top product-energy selection	0	58.8/94.9/125.4 (93.0)	$4.34 \to 10.68^{+1.54}_{-1.48}$	$4.70 \to 14.09^{+1.77}_{-1.75}$	$4.91 \to 17.86^{+2.03}_{-1.94}$	$4.65 \to 14.21\%$	-8.21 ($[-9.88, -6.47]$)
TQA	Homogeneous annealing ramp, 32-pt Δt quantum energy selection	32	99.7/121.0/134.2 (118.3)	$4.60 \to 17.05^{+0.56}_{-0.56}$	$6.81 \to 21.94^{+0.68}_{-0.68}$	$8.23 \to 28.27^{+0.92}_{-0.91}$	$6.55 \to 22.42\%$	Reference (0.00)
Echo-MF-Alt	Classical mean-field marginals + 1D Alternating overlap	0	95.7/121.9/135.2 (117.6)	$3.00 \to 8.53^{+0.84}_{-0.82}$	$2.73 \to 13.53^{+1.18}_{-1.22}$	$2.77 \to 18.65^{+1.47}_{-1.58}$	$2.83 \to 13.57\%$	-8.85 ($[-9.72, -7.98]$)
Echo-MF-End	Classical mean-field marginals + 1D Endpoint overlap	0	94.1/126.6/139.5 (120.1)	$4.43 \to 13.10^{+1.25}_{-1.23}$	$4.44 \to 18.24^{+1.43}_{-1.42}$	$4.45 \to 22.83^{+1.65}_{-1.57}$	$4.44 \to 18.06\%$	-4.36 ($[-5.61, -3.11]$)
Echo-MF-Flat	Classical mean-field marginals + 1D Flat-Top overlap	**0**	71.6/102.5/125.1 (99.8)	$5.13 \to 16.05^{+1.52}_{-1.56}$	$5.39 \to 23.23^{+1.83}_{-1.92}$	$5.69 \to 29.28^{+2.08}_{-2.17}$	$5.40 \to 22.85\%$	$+0.43$ ($[-1.26, +2.08]$)
Echo-MF-2kD	**Temp.-continuation cluster orientation + staged $2k$-D adjoint refinement**	**0**	**46.7/63.6/84.1 (64.8)**	$\mathbf{29.28 \to 30.98^{+1.67}_{-1.68}}$	$\mathbf{42.20 \to 46.70^{+1.78}_{-1.90}}$	$\mathbf{53.85 \to 60.80^{+1.82}_{-1.91}}$	$\mathbf{41.77 \to 46.16\%}$	$\mathbf{+23.74}$ ($[+22.06, +25.43]$)

Across all 1,024 held-out MWIS center test instances ($n = 10, p \in \{8, 10, 12\}$), `Echo-MF-2kD` resolves the accuracy–efficiency dilemma by achieving a cross-depth mean final ground-state probability of **46.16**% (**30.98**%, **46.70**%, **60.80**% at $p = 8, 10, 12$), outperforming 32-evaluation online `TQA` (22.42%) by **+23.74** pp

(2.06× TQA), 32-evaluation RI (32) (9.73%) by +36.43 pp (4.74×), and 1D Echo-MF-Flat (22.85%) by +23.31 pp (Figure 2a, b and Table 2). Before executing a single quantum circuit evaluation, the Stage-1 classical product state prepared by Echo-MF-2kD already attains a mean initial probability $P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)}$ of **41.77**% (**53.85**% at $p = 12$)—reaching 1.86× the *final post-optimization* probability of TQA after 32 selection and 118.3 gradient quantum evaluations. In the instance-level ECDF (Figure 2c, d), Echo-MF-2kD achieves per-instance win rates over TQA of 60.8%–80.6% (paired gains +13.93–+32.53 pp) and lifts high-probability instance coverage ($P_{\mathrm{gs}} \geq 50\%$) to **45.7**%, versus 3.6% for TQA (12.7×) and 18.6% for Echo-MF-Flat (2.5×).

Mechanistically, this simultaneous leap in solution quality and search speed stems from pre-aligning single-qubit phases inside the true ground-state basin on the $2k$-dimensional product manifold. Because homogeneous TQA ramps and random starts begin far from the heterogeneous ground state ($P_{\mathrm{gs}}^{(0)}$ of 4.60%–8.23% and 0.17%–0.22%), their Stage-2 L-BFGS-B trajectories must traverse rugged non-convex ridges, consuming an average of 118.3 and 134.0 gradient quantum evaluations. In contrast, Echo-MF-2kD locks onto the correct single-qubit spin orientation with 96.45% accuracy (full-instance hit rate 94.92%) and places 76.8%, 86.8%, 91.0% of instances directly inside the all-qubit target quadrant at $p = 8, 10, 12$. Starting deep within the target basin, Stage-2 L-BFGS-B requires only minor local coupling adjustments, converging in **46.7**, **63.6**, **84.1** gradient evaluations (mean **64.8**—a **45.2**% reduction relative to TQA, 51.6% relative to RI (32), and 35.1% relative to Echo-MF-Flat). Furthermore, unlike circuit-modifying Warm-Start QAOA[32,33] or parameter-inflated ma-QAOA[34] (requiring 38× more parameter-shift circuit executions at $n = 10, p = 10$), Echo-MF-2kD operates strictly within the unmodified $2p$-angle global QAOA circuit.

Cross-scale scaling laws across 5,120 instances and five Ising families

Table 3. Cross-scale MWIS evaluation across $n \in \{6, 8, 10, 12, 14\}$ at fixed depth $p = 10$ (1,024 unseen test instances per scale; 5,120 instances total). The left block reports offline uncapped equal-candidate (Top-1 and Top-2) final ground-state probabilities (%) and paired net gains of Echo-Flat-2kD over TQA. The right block reports online training-free Echo-MF-2kD (0 Stage-1 quantum evaluations) and 1D Echo-MF-Flat versus online TQA (32 Stage-1 quantum evaluations) on the identical 5,120 instances, including single-qubit spin orientation accuracy, initial → final ground-state probabilities (%), and mean Stage-2 gradient quantum calls. Bold denotes the best value in each comparison group.

Size n (Count)	Offline Echo-Flat-1D (Top-1)	Offline Echo-Flat-2kD (Top-1 / Top-2)	Offline TQA (Top-1 / Top-2)	Offline Echo-Flat-2kD vs. TQA (Top-1, pp)	Online Echo-MF-2kD Spin Acc.	Online Echo-MF-Flat (1D, 0 evals)	Online Echo-MF-2kD ($2k$-D, 0 evals)	Online TQA (32 evals)	Stage-2 Quantum Calls (Echo-MF-2kD / TQA)
6 (1,024)	$94.37^{+0.69}_{-0.73}$	$\mathbf{96.79}^{+0.48}_{-0.53}$ / $\mathbf{97.44}^{+0.39}_{-0.42}$	$59.88^{+1.14}_{-1.13}$ / $62.18^{+1.15}_{-1.15}$	**+36.91** ([+35.74, +38.02])	99.61%	$36.16 \rightarrow 68.49^{+2.34}_{-2.48}$	$91.00 \rightarrow \mathbf{94.02}^{+0.96}_{-1.06}$	$20.71 \rightarrow 45.19^{+1.15}_{-1.14}$	**79.3** / 129.0
8 (1,024)	$77.25^{+1.36}_{-1.34}$	$\mathbf{85.01}^{+0.92}_{-0.93}$ / $\mathbf{87.18}^{+0.83}_{-0.81}$	$43.62^{+1.07}_{-1.02}$ / $45.53^{+1.08}_{-1.04}$	**+41.39** ([+40.10, +42.72])	98.32%	$15.96 \rightarrow 45.11^{+2.41}_{-2.40}$	$69.41 \rightarrow \mathbf{74.99}^{+1.65}_{-1.68}$	$12.07 \rightarrow 31.64^{+0.95}_{-0.93}$	**68.6** / 121.7
10 (1,024)	$53.08^{+1.51}_{-1.57}$	$\mathbf{64.29}^{+1.22}_{-1.24}$ / $\mathbf{67.41}^{+1.13}_{-1.14}$	$31.52^{+0.82}_{-0.84}$ / $33.06^{+0.86}_{-0.90}$	**+32.76** ([+31.35, +34.17])	96.45%	$5.39 \rightarrow 23.23^{+1.83}_{-1.92}$	$42.20 \rightarrow \mathbf{46.70}^{+1.78}_{-1.90}$	$6.81 \rightarrow 21.94^{+0.68}_{-0.68}$	**63.6** / 121.0
12 (1,024)	$29.64^{+1.33}_{-1.25}$	$\mathbf{41.41}^{+1.18}_{-1.15}$ / $\mathbf{45.51}^{+1.10}_{-1.11}$	$23.45^{+0.69}_{-0.66}$ / $24.48^{+0.69}_{-0.67}$	**+17.96** ([+16.75, +19.16])	95.57%	$1.26 \rightarrow 9.74^{+1.21}_{-1.12}$	$21.38 \rightarrow \mathbf{22.64}^{+1.31}_{-1.38}$	$3.88 \rightarrow 15.55^{+0.54}_{-0.50}$	**62.6** / 119.6
14 (1,024)	$17.47^{+0.96}_{-0.96}$	$\mathbf{24.84}^{+0.95}_{-0.93}$ / $\mathbf{27.86}^{+0.95}_{-0.91}$	$17.23^{+0.58}_{-0.53}$ / $18.16^{+0.62}_{-0.57}$	**+7.61** ([+6.66, +8.57])	93.75%	$0.46 \rightarrow 4.32^{+0.70}_{-0.66}$	$\mathbf{10.12} \rightarrow 10.13^{+0.93}_{-0.90}$	$2.17 \rightarrow \mathbf{10.94}^{+0.44}_{-0.40}$	**61.3** / 119.8

Evaluating 5,120 unseen MWIS test instances across $n \in \{6, 8, 10, 12, 14\}$ at fixed depth $p = 10$ ($2k = 10$ manifold parameters) reveals how $2k$-dimensional refinement reshapes scaling in the overcomplete $n > 2k$ regime (Figure 3a, b and Table 3). In offline equal-candidate comparisons (Table 3, left), 1D Echo-Flat-1D (Top-1) suffers severe Diophantine frequency crowding once $n \geq 12 > 2k$, with initial product probabilities dropping to 3.69% ($n = 12$) and 1.29% ($n = 14$). Unlocking all $2k = 10$ intra-pair degrees of freedom in Echo-Flat-2kD boosts initial product probabilities by 6.2–8.6× in the overcomplete regime (to 22.87% at $n = 12$ and 11.08% at $n = 14$). After Stage-2 recoupling, Echo-Flat-2kD (Top-1) outperforms both TQA (Top-1) and Echo-Flat-1D (Top-1) across all five system sizes with paired net gains over TQA of **+36.91**, **+41.39**, **+32.76**, **+17.96**, and **+7.61** pp (reaching Top-1 / Top-2 probabilities of **64.29**%/**67.41**%, **41.41**%/**45.51**%, and **24.84**%/**27.86**% at $n = 10, 12, 14$; all 95% CIs strictly positive).

In online training-free mode (Table 3, right), 1D soft-marginal overlap decoding (Echo-MF-Flat) outperforms TQA at $n \leq 10$ but collapses at $n = 12, 14$ (9.74%, 4.32%) as unoriented soft marginals compound 1D frequency crowding. Conversely, temperature-continuation cluster orientation in Echo-MF-2kD sustains 93.75%–99.61% single-qubit orientation accuracy across all 5,120 instances. With zero Stage-1 measurements, Echo-MF-2kD achieves final probabilities of **94.02**%, **74.99**%, **46.70**%, **22.64**% across $n = 6, 8, 10, 12$—beating 32-evaluation online TQA by **+48.83**, **+43.35**, **+24.76**, **+7.09** pp while cutting Stage-2 quantum gradient calls roughly in half (**61.3**–**79.3** versus 119.6–129.0). At $n = 14$, where large conflict penalties ($Q = 2 \max_i v_i$) steepen excited-state energy barriers, Echo-MF-2kD's zero-measurement Stage-1 classical product state (**10.12**%, 4.7× TQA's initial 2.17% and 22× Echo-MF-Flat's 0.46%) already matches the final post-optimization probability of online TQA (10.94%).

This mechanistic scaling extends across the five canonical Ising benchmark families (MWIS, Dense Ising, Sparse Ising, Grid Ising, and Pinned MaxCut[39]) in uncapped $n = 11, 12$ ($p = 10$, 500 instances) boundary experiments (Extended Data Table 1). Echo-Flat-2kD yields +12.05 and +10.57 pp gains over Echo-Flat-1D on heterogeneous-field MWIS (**56.69**% and **41.66**%, beating TQA by **+28.81** and **+16.56** pp), elevates Stage-1 initial product probabilities on zero-mean Gaussian Dense, Sparse, and Grid Ising from 5.05%–9.12% (Echo-Flat-1D)

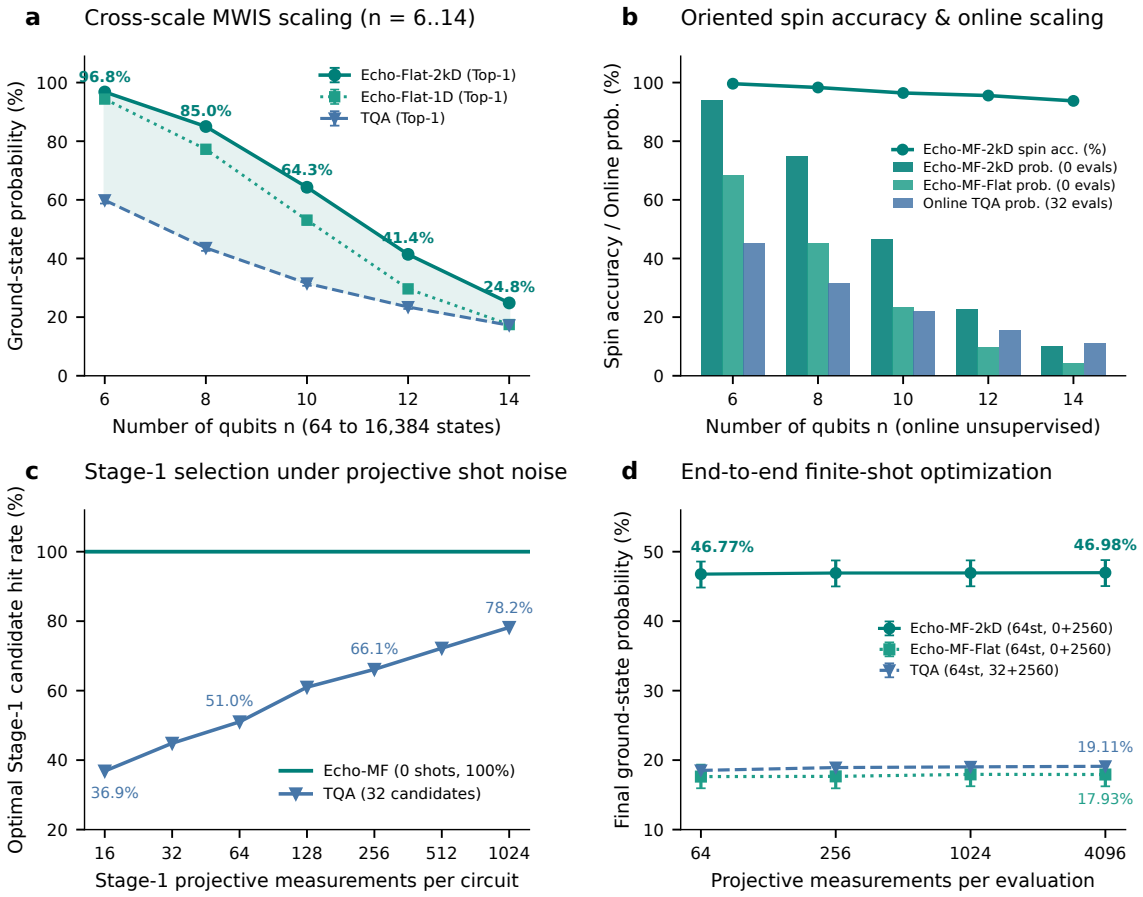


Figure 3. Cross-scale scaling across 5,120 MWIS test instances ($n \in \{6, 8, 10, 12, 14\}$) and immunity to projective measurement shot noise. **a**, Uncapped equal-candidate (Top-1) offline scaling curves on MWIS at fixed depth $p = 10$ ($k = 5$ pairs) from $n = 6$ to $n = 14$ (64 to 16,384 Hilbert-space dimensions, 1,024 unseen instances per scale) comparing `Echo-Flat-2kD`, `Echo-Flat-1D`, and `TQA`. **b**, Online training-free scaling on the exact same 5,120 instances showing oriented single-qubit spin accuracy (top curve) and zero-quantum-selection final ground-state probabilities of `Echo-MF-2kD` versus 32-evaluation online `TQA` and 1D `Echo-MF-Flat` (bottom bars). **c**, Stage-1 candidate selection shot-noise test ($n = 10, p = 10$, 1,024 instances) comparing `TQA`'s hit rate for selecting its noiseless optimal step size across $N_{\text{shots}} \in \{16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512, 1024\}$ against zero-quantum-measurement `Echo-MF` (identically 100%). **d**, End-to-end finite-shot parameter-shift variational optimization ($n = 10, p = 10$, 1,024 instances, 64 steps) across $N_{\text{shots}} \in \{64, 256, 1024, 4096\}$. All error bars and shaded bands denote 4,000-resample bootstrap 95% CIs.

to 24.70%–37.47%, and surpasses online `TQA` across all four non-zero-field families. Conversely, on the negative-control family `Pinned MaxCut` where interior local fields vanish identically ($h_i = 0$), both 1D and $2k$D initial probabilities remain strictly bounded by 2^{-n_0} (0.20%–0.37%), confirming our theoretical premise that complete spin-echo pair evolution is driven specifically by non-vanishing local external fields H_h.

Shot-noise immunity and early-stopping efficiency

Under realistic quantum hardware execution, projective measurements introduce multinomial shot noise of scale $O(N_{\text{shots}}^{-1/2})$ into every energy evaluation. Across all 1,024 held-out MWIS center test instances ($n = 10, p = 10$), online `TQA` suffers severe Stage-1 misselection ("Winner's Curse") when picking the lowest empirical energy among its 32 candidate step sizes (Figure 3c and Extended Data Table 2): at $N_{\text{shots}} = 16, 32, 64$, statistical fluctuations limit `TQA`'s noiseless-optimum hit rate to 36.86%, 44.86%, 51.02%, reaching only 78.20% at $N_{\text{shots}} = 1024$. Because `Echo-MF-2kD` and `Echo-MF-Flat` execute Stage-1 manifold refinement deterministically on a classical processor with zero quantum measurements, their Stage-1 candidate selection is 100% immune to shot noise across all shot budgets.

When both Stage-1 selection and 64-step Stage-2 parameter-shift gradient optimization ($2 \times 2p = 40$ circuit executions per step) operate under finite measurement shots $N_{\text{shots}} \in \{64, 256, 1024, 4096\}$, `Echo-MF-2kD` achieves substantial measurement savings and noise resilience (Figure 3d and Extended Data Table 2). With zero quantum measurements (0 steps), `Echo-MF-2kD`'s classical product initial state ($\mathbf{42.20}^{+1.55}_{-1.70}$%) already exceeds 2.2×

the final probability of 64-step noisy `TQA` (18.52%–19.11% after 2,592 circuit evaluations). With early stopping at 16 steps (640 evaluations, saving 75.3% of shots) and 32 steps (1,280 evaluations, saving 50.6% of shots), `Echo-MF-2kD` reaches 44.03%–44.73% and 45.60%–46.28%, outperforming 64-step `TQA` by **+25.51**–**+25.62** pp and **+27.08**–**+27.20** pp. At 64 steps (2,560 evaluations), `Echo-MF-2kD` reaches **46.77**%–**46.98**%, a paired net gain of **+27.87**–**+28.25** pp over `TQA`.

Discussion

By proving that exact spin-echo parity cancellation of quadratic couplings H_J extends from a 1D scalar ray to the entire $2k$-dimensional complete-pair submanifold inside the unmodified depth-$2k$ global QAOA circuit, this work establishes an exact equivalence between multi-body quantum expected energy and classical product-state energy: $\langle\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g},\boldsymbol{\theta})|H_C|\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g},\boldsymbol{\theta})\rangle \equiv E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g},\boldsymbol{\theta})$. This structural insight resolves the long-standing tension between hardware-native circuit execution and site-specific phase initialization. Rather than modifying the quantum circuit ansatz with site-customized mixers[32,33] or expending online quantum evaluations on homogeneous annealing grids[23], `Echo-MF-2kD` exploits the hidden integrable $2k$-dimensional product submanifold to align heterogeneous single-qubit phases and suppress effective-field inversions purely on a classical processor before launching full-angle quantum entanglement optimization.

Beyond QAOA, our three-stage division of labor—classical mean-field topological orientation, exact adjoint control on an embedded symmetry-decoupled product manifold, and symmetry-breaking multi-body recoupling[44]—provides a general methodological blueprint for parameterized quantum circuits and many-body variational simulation. Whenever a target Hamiltonian decomposes into terms of opposite parity under a global hardware-native symmetry operation (such as global Pauli flips in spin lattices or particle-hole conjugation in fermionic systems), inserting symmetry pivots carves out a classically tractable low-dimensional submanifold within the deep variational ansatz. Pre-optimizing classical surrogate energies and local stability guards on this exact submanifold via $O(kn)$ reverse-mode SU(2) adjoint differentiation avoids barren plateaus and shot-noise misselection while reducing classical preprocessing from $O(n^{3.5})$ semidefinite programming to sparse-graph linear complexity $O(T_{\text{mf}}|E| + kn)$.

Our theoretical assumptions and cross-family experiments also delineate two clear operational boundaries. First, because single-qubit phase evolution $e^{-2ig_jH_h}$ on the complete Echo-pair submanifold is generated exclusively by local external fields H_h, problems with identically zero local fields ($h = 0$, such as unweighted MaxCut or interior vertices of `Pinned MaxCut`) experience no phase differentiation on the pure Echo manifold; extending `Echo-MF-2kD` to field-free graphs requires pinning a reference vertex or applying a single mean-field symmetry-breaking layer to induce effective local fields. Second, when system size scales into the deep overcomplete regime ($n = 14 > 2k = 10$) under large constraint penalties ($Q = 2\max_i v_i$), although `Echo-MF-2kD`'s zero-measurement Stage-1 product state (10.12%) matches the final post-optimization probability of online `TQA` (10.94%), Stage-2 optimization of the expected energy $\langle H_C\rangle$ prioritizes suppressing high-penalty excited tails over amplifying the ground-state peak (10.12% → 10.13%). Replacing the Stage-2 expected-energy objective with tail-focused Conditional Value-at-Risk (CVaR) objectives or scaling circuit depth proportionally with system size ($p \propto n$) on neutral Rydberg atom arrays offers a direct path to hundred-qubit constrained quantum optimization.

Methods

Problem Formulation and Theoretical Preliminaries

Normalized Ising Hamiltonian and standard global QAOA ansatz. We consider an n-qubit Ising energy function with local external fields over spin configurations $s \in \{-1,+1\}^n$ (mapped to binary variables via $x_i = (1+s_i)/2 \in \{0,1\}$):

$$E(s) = \frac{1}{2}s^\top Js + h^\top s + C, \qquad s \in \{-1,+1\}^n,$$

where $J \in \mathbb{R}^{n\times n}$ is symmetric with zero diagonal and $h \in \mathbb{R}^n$ is the local external field vector. To standardize energy scales across problem families and graph sizes without altering configuration ordering or energy gap ratios, raw coefficients $(J_{\text{raw}}, h_{\text{raw}}, C_{\text{raw}})$ are normalized by the per-qubit root-mean-square (RMS) scale factor $\lambda = \sqrt{(\|J_{\text{raw}}\|_F^2 + \|h_{\text{raw}}\|_2^2)/n}$ to yield $J = J_{\text{raw}}/\lambda$, $h = h_{\text{raw}}/\lambda$, and $C = 0$, satisfying $(\|J\|_F^2 + \|h\|_2^2)/n = 1$. In the 2^n-dimensional Hilbert space with computational basis states $|s\rangle$ and diagonal spin operators $S_i = \text{diag}(-1,+1) = -Z_i$, the problem Hamiltonian is $H_C = H_J + H_h$, where $H_J = \sum_{1\le i<j\le n} J_{ij}S_iS_j$ and $H_h = \sum_{i=1}^n h_iS_i$. A depth-$p$ standard global QAOA circuit applies alternating cost unitaries $U_C(\gamma_\ell) = e^{-i\gamma_\ell H_C}$ and global transverse-field mixer unitaries $U_B(\beta_\ell) = e^{-i\beta_\ell\sum_{i=1}^n X_i}$ to the uniform superposition $|+\rangle^{\otimes n}$, preparing $|\psi_p(\vartheta)\rangle = U_B(\beta_p)U_C(\gamma_p)\cdots U_B(\beta_1)U_C(\gamma_1)|+\rangle^{\otimes n}$ parameterized by $\vartheta = (\gamma_1,\ldots,\gamma_p,\beta_1,\ldots,\beta_p) \in [-10\pi,10\pi]^p \times [-\pi/2,\pi/2)^p$.

Complete spin-echo pair decoupling on the $2k$-dimensional submanifold. Define the global spin-flip parity operator $F = \prod_{i=1}^{n} X_i$, which satisfies $F^\dagger = F$, $F^2 = I$, $F|s\rangle = |-s\rangle$, and $U_B(\pi/2) = (-i)^n F$. Under conjugation by F, the quadratic coupling and local field operators obey opposite parity relations:

$$FH_JF = H_J, \qquad FH_hF = -H_h.$$

For any positive even circuit depth $p = 2k$ ($k \geq 1$), we partition the $2k$ layers into k adjacent *complete spin-echo pairs* ($j = 1, \ldots, k$) by assigning anti-symmetric cost angles $(\gamma_{2j-1}, \gamma_{2j}) = (-g_j, g_j)$ and mixer angles $(\beta_{2j-1}, \beta_{2j}) = (\pi/2, \theta_j)$[39]. Because H_C and FH_CF are diagonal in the computational basis and commute ($[H_C, FH_CF] = 0$), the composite two-layer unitary of the j-th pair simplifies identically (up to the global phase $(-i)^n$) to

$$E(g_j, \theta_j) = U_B(\theta_j)e^{-ig_jH_C}Fe^{ig_jH_C} = U_B(\theta_j)e^{-ig_j(H_J+H_h)}e^{ig_j(FH_JF+FH_hF)}F = U_B(\theta_j)e^{-2ig_jH_h}F.$$

Because H_J cancels identically within each pair for any $(g_j, \theta_j) \in \mathbb{R}^2$, the $2p$-layer circuit unitary across the entire $2k$-dimensional complete-pair submanifold $(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = (g_1, \ldots, g_k, \theta_1, \ldots, \theta_k) \in \mathbb{R}^k \times \mathbb{R}^k$ decomposes into single-qubit operators, preparing the exact product state $|\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})\rangle = \bigotimes_{i=1}^{n} u_i^{(k)}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$. In the single-qubit basis ($|s_i = -1\rangle, |s_i = +1\rangle$) starting from $u_i^{(0)} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(1, 1)^\top$, the spinor $u_i^{(j)} = (u_{i,-}^{(j)}, u_{i,+}^{(j)})^\top$ evolves across $j = 1, \ldots, k$ via the 2×2 unitary recursion

$$\begin{pmatrix} u_{i,-}^{(j)} \\ u_{i,+}^{(j)} \end{pmatrix} = M(\theta_j)\begin{pmatrix} e^{2ig_jh_i}u_{i,+}^{(j-1)} \\ e^{-2ig_jh_i}u_{i,-}^{(j-1)} \end{pmatrix}, \qquad M(\theta_j) = \begin{pmatrix} \cos\theta_j & -i\sin\theta_j \\ -i\sin\theta_j & \cos\theta_j \end{pmatrix}.$$

Exact quantum–classical product-energy identity and first-order Stage-2 recoupling. Denoting the terminal positive-spin probability of qubit i by $p_i^+(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = |u_{i,+}^{(k)}|^2$ and its magnetization by $m_i(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = 2p_i^+(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) - 1 = |u_{i,+}^{(k)}|^2 - |u_{i,-}^{(k)}|^2 \in [-1, 1]$, the probability of measuring any target configuration $s^\star \in \{-1, +1\}^n$ is $P(s^\star) = \prod_{i=1}^{n} \frac{1+s_i^\star m_i}{2}$. Because distinct qubits are unentangled on the $2k$-dimensional submanifold, two-body spin correlations factorize exactly ($\langle\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})|S_iS_j|\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})\rangle = m_im_j$ for all $i \neq j$), yielding the exact operator expectation identity $\langle\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})|H_C|\psi_p(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})\rangle \equiv E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{2}\boldsymbol{m}^\top J\boldsymbol{m} + \boldsymbol{h}^\top\boldsymbol{m} + C$. When Stage-2 optimization perturbs the j-th pair's cost angles along the symmetry-breaking direction $(\gamma_{2j-1}, \gamma_{2j}) = (-g_j + \delta_j, g_j + \delta_j)$, commuting F through $e^{i(g_j+\delta_j)H_C}$ yields $E(g_j, \theta_j; \delta_j) = U_B(\theta_j)e^{-2i\delta_jH_J}e^{-2ig_jH_h}F$, which re-activates the quadratic coupling generator $-2iH_J$ linearly at $O(\delta_j)$.

Module Design and Algorithmic Procedure

Damped mean-field inference and temperature-continuation cluster orientation. Given an unseen instance (J, h) in online mode, Stage 1 first estimates soft spin polarizations by running T_{mf} damped mean-field iterations[45] with damping factor $\alpha_{\text{d}} \in (0, 1)$ at a characteristic inverse temperature $\beta_{\text{mf}}^\star > 0$ from $\boldsymbol{m}^{(0)} = \mathbf{0}$:

$$m_i^{(t)} = (1 - \alpha_{\text{d}})m_i^{(t-1)} + \alpha_{\text{d}} \tanh\left[-\beta_{\text{mf}}^\star\left(h_i + \sum_{j=1}^{n} J_{ij}m_j^{(t-1)}\right)\right], \qquad \pi_i^{\text{mf}} = \frac{1 + m_i^{(T_{\text{mf}})}}{2}.$$

While 1D `Echo-MF-Flat` decodes $\boldsymbol{\pi}^{\text{mf}}$ directly via 1D distribution overlap $S(a) = \prod_{i=1}^{n}[\pi_i^{\text{mf}}q_i(a) + (1 - \pi_i^{\text{mf}})(1 - q_i(a))]$[39], soft marginals on frustrated edges can remain near 0.5 and pull multi-scalar optimization toward conflicting basins. To lock onto a self-consistent binary target orientation $\hat{\boldsymbol{s}} \in \{-1, +1\}^n$ deterministically, we construct a candidate seed pool from $2\boldsymbol{\pi}^{\text{mf}} - \mathbf{1}$ and single-spin flips on the most uncertain qubits, propagate each seed through damped mean-field updates across an ascending inverse-temperature schedule $\beta_1 < \beta_2 < \beta_3$, and apply zero-temperature greedy single-spin flips and adjacent conflicting-edge (i, j) two-spin swaps that strictly decrease the classical Ising energy $\frac{1}{2}\boldsymbol{s}^\top J\boldsymbol{s} + \boldsymbol{h}^\top\boldsymbol{s}$, selecting the lowest-energy self-consistent orientation $\hat{\boldsymbol{s}}$.

1D Daubechies maximally flat anchors and zero-free interval convexity. To initialize optimization on the $2k$-dimensional submanifold, we extract resonance anchors along the 1D Daubechies maximally flat ray $\boldsymbol{g}(a) = a\boldsymbol{r}^{\text{flat}}$ with dyadic ratio $\boldsymbol{r}^{\text{flat}} = (1, 2, \ldots, 2)$ and pre-synthesized maximally flat even-layer mixer angles $\boldsymbol{\theta}^{\text{flat}} \in [-\pi/2, \pi/2)^k$ obtained via Daubechies spectral factorization and two-channel lattice reduction[39,40,46]. Under this 1D response, single-qubit positive-spin probability is given by the regularized incomplete Beta function $p_k(q) = I_q(k, k) = q^k\sum_{r=0}^{k-1}\binom{k-1+r}{r}(1 - q)^r$ with $q = (1 + \sin(4ah_i))/2$. For any target orientation $\hat{\boldsymbol{s}} \in \{-1, +1\}^n$, let $w_i = 4h_i\hat{s}_i$ and phase error $e_i(a) = \text{wrap}_{(-\pi,\pi]}(aw_i - \pi/2)$. Because the single-qubit negative log-likelihood $\ell_k(e) = -\ln p_k((1 + \cos e)/2)$ has a strictly increasing first derivative on $(-\pi, \pi)$ governed by the log-concave kernel $\sin^{2k-1} v$, the 1D negative log-likelihood $\mathcal{L}_k(a) = \sum_{i=1}^{n}\ell_k(e_i(a))$ is *strictly convex* in a on every open interval bounded by the adjacent zero-probability singularities $a = (-\pi/2 + 2\pi z)/w_i$ ($z \in \mathbb{Z}$). Enumerating all singularity

breakpoints on $[-G, G]$ and applying deterministic derivative bisection within each zero-free open interval extracts the top M_{anc} separated minima $a^{(m)}$, defining initial manifold anchors $(\boldsymbol{g}^{(0,m)}, \boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)}) = (a^{(m)}\boldsymbol{r}^{\text{flat}}, \boldsymbol{\theta}^{\text{flat}})$.

Composite physical objective and exact $O(kn)$ reverse-mode SU(2)-adjoint refinement. Denote the active non-zero-field qubit set by $NZ = \{i : h_i \neq 0\}$, the target-direction spin probability by $\pi_i(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = p_i^+(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})^{\mathbf{1}[\hat{s}_i=+1]}(1 - p_i^+(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}))^{\mathbf{1}[\hat{s}_i=-1]}$, and the local effective field by $h_i^{\text{eff}}(\boldsymbol{m}) = h_i + (J\boldsymbol{m})_i$. To prioritize qubits subject to strong effective drives and prevent Stage-2 local field inversions, we define normalized flip-sensitivity weights $w_i = 1 + \kappa_w |h_i + (J\hat{\boldsymbol{s}})_i| / (\frac{1}{|NZ|}\sum_{j\in NZ} |h_j + (J\hat{\boldsymbol{s}})_j|)$ and formulate the composite manifold objective

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = &- \sum_{i\in NZ} w_i \ln \pi_i(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) + \lambda_{\text{quad}} \sum_{i\in NZ} w_i \,\text{softplus}\big(\tau_{\text{quad}}(\pi_{\text{safe}} - \pi_i(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}))\big) \\ &+ \frac{\lambda_{\text{inv}}}{\tau_{\text{inv}}} \sum_{i\in NZ} \text{softplus}\big(\tau_{\text{inv}}(\hat{s}_i h_i^{\text{eff}}(\boldsymbol{m}) + \delta_{\text{inv}})\big) + \alpha_E E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) \\ &+ \frac{\mu_g}{2}\|\boldsymbol{g} - \boldsymbol{g}^{(0)}\|_2^2 + \frac{\mu_\theta}{2}\|\boldsymbol{\theta} - \boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)}\|_2^2.\end{aligned}$$

Here, the first two terms drive all active qubits into the correct target hemisphere above safety margin $\pi_{\text{safe}} > 0.5$; the third term is the *local effective-field inversion guard*, which penalizes states where $\hat{s}_i h_i^{\text{eff}}(\boldsymbol{m}) > -\delta_{\text{inv}}$ so that each spin remains energetically aligned against its local effective field upon Stage-2 coupling activation; the fourth term minimizes the exact classical product energy E_{prod}; and the final two terms regularize deviations from the Daubechies anchor $(\boldsymbol{g}^{(0)}, \boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)})$.

Exact gradients $\nabla_{(\boldsymbol{g},\boldsymbol{\theta})}\mathcal{L}$ are computed in $O(kn + n^2)$ operations via reverse-mode SU(2)-adjoint differentiation. Initializing the terminal adjoint spinor $\bar{u}_i^{(k)} = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial u_i^{(k)*}} = (0,\ \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial p_i^+} u_{i,+}^{(k)})^\top$ from $\frac{\partial E_{\text{prod}}}{\partial p_i^+} = 2h_i^{\text{eff}}(\boldsymbol{m})$ and $\frac{\partial \pi_i}{\partial p_i^+} = \hat{s}_i$, and denoting the post-phase intermediate spinor at pair j by $\tilde{u}_i^{(j)} = (e^{2ig_j h_i} u_{i,+}^{(j-1)},\ e^{-2ig_j h_i} u_{i,-}^{(j-1)})^\top$, backward recursion from $j = k$ down to $j = 1$ yields

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \theta_j} = \mu_\theta(\theta_j - \theta_j^{(0)}) + 2\,\text{Re}\sum_{i=1}^{n} \big(\bar{u}_i^{(j)}\big)^\dagger \frac{dM(\theta_j)}{d\theta_j}\tilde{u}_i^{(j)}, \qquad \tilde{\bar{u}}_i^{(j)} = M(\theta_j)^\dagger \bar{u}_i^{(j)},$$

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial g_j} = \mu_g(g_j - g_j^{(0)}) + 2\,\text{Re}\sum_{i=1}^{n} 2ih_i\Big[\big(\tilde{\bar{u}}_{i,-}^{(j)}\big)^* \tilde{u}_{i,-}^{(j)} - \big(\tilde{\bar{u}}_{i,+}^{(j)}\big)^* \tilde{u}_{i,+}^{(j)}\Big], \qquad \begin{pmatrix}\bar{u}_{i,-}^{(j-1)} \\ \bar{u}_{i,+}^{(j-1)}\end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} e^{2ig_j h_i}\tilde{\bar{u}}_{i,+}^{(j)} \\ e^{-2ig_j h_i}\tilde{\bar{u}}_{i,-}^{(j)}\end{pmatrix}.$$

To prevent even-layer mixers from degenerating into pure spin flips ($|\theta_j| \to \pi/2$, which would freeze transverse mixing in Stage 2), we enforce the non-degenerate mixer bound $|\theta_j| \le \theta_{\max} < \pi/2$ and trust-region box constraints around each anchor. Refinement proceeds in two stages: Step 1a optimizes the k cost angles $\boldsymbol{g}$ with $\boldsymbol{\theta} = \boldsymbol{\theta}^{(0)}$ fixed; when $|NZ| > k$, Step 1b jointly optimizes all $2k$ parameters $(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$. Across refined anchors, the candidate minimizing E_{prod} with maximum all-qubit quadrant satisfaction is expanded into the $2p$-dimensional starting point ϑ_0.

Experimental Protocol and Evaluation Setup

Benchmark datasets and controlled instance verification. Experiments are conducted on two verified benchmark suites sharing RMS normalization and exact two-step unique-ground-state verification:

1. *MWIS learning and cross-scale benchmark (`data/mwis`)*: Connected sparse graphs (Hamiltonian cycle plus random edges with expected degree 3, vertex weights $v_i \sim \mathcal{U}(0.5, 1.5)$, and conflict penalty $Q = 2\max_i v_i$ guaranteeing that all local and global energy minima are valid independent sets). The center $n = 10$ dataset comprises 4,096 training, 512 validation, and 1,024 held-out test instances evaluated across $p \in \{8, 10, 12\}$ ($k \in \{4, 5, 6\}$). Large-sample cross-scale generalization is evaluated at fixed depth $p = 10$ across $n \in \{6, 8, 10, 12, 14\}$ with 1,024 unseen test instances per scale (5,120 test instances total, spanning 64 to 16,384 Hilbert-space dimensions).
2. *Five-family Ising benchmark (`data/benchmark`)*: Encompasses `Dense Ising`, `Sparse Ising`, `Grid Ising`, `MWIS`, and `Pinned MaxCut` (50 instances per family per size across $n = 6 \ldots 16$, 2,750 instances total, including the 500-instance uncapped mechanistic boundary suite at $n \in \{11, 12\}, p = 10$).

Baseline fairness and two-stage evaluation protocol. All compared methods are evaluated under a unified two-stage protocol (Stage-1 initialization → Stage-2 continuous full-angle optimization). In online training-free comparisons (Table 2 and Table 3 right), every initializer receives exclusively (J, h) with zero training data: `RI (1)` samples a single random starting point (0 Stage-1 evaluations); `RI (32)` and online `TQA` ($\gamma_\ell = \Delta t(\ell - 0.5)/p$,

$\beta_\ell = -\Delta t(1-(\ell-0.5)/p))$ evaluate 32 candidates on the quantum circuit objective $\langle H_C \rangle$ to select the lowest-energy start (32 Stage-1 quantum evaluations); `Echo-Energy`, `Echo-MF-Alt`, `Echo-MF-End`, and `Echo-MF-Flat` scan 128 uniform scalar points on $[-10\pi, 10\pi]$ classically (0 Stage-1 quantum evaluations); and `Echo-MF-2kD` performs staged $2k$-dimensional adjoint refinement (0 Stage-1 quantum evaluations). All Stage-1 starting points $\vartheta_0 \in \mathbb{R}^{2p}$ are passed to the identical Stage-2 L-BFGS-B quantum energy optimizer, returning the lowest-energy evaluated point ϑ_{best} for independent ground-state probability scoring $P_{\text{gs}} = |\langle s^\star | \psi_p(\vartheta_{\text{best}}) \rangle|^2$. In offline equal-candidate comparisons (Table 1 top and Table 3 left), `Echo-Flat-2kD`, `Echo-Flat-1D`, and `TQA` are compared under strictly matched candidate budgets (`Top-1` and `Top-2`) without wall-clock truncation.

Finite-shot projective noise and statistical inference. Shot-noise experiments on the 1,024-instance $n = 10, p = 10$ MWIS test set evaluate both Stage-1 candidate selection under multinomial projective sampling (Regime A, $N_{\text{shots}} \in \{16, 32, 64, 128, 256, 512, 1024\}$, 5 independent trials per instance) and end-to-end noisy variational optimization (Regime B, Stage-1 noisy selection followed by 64 steps of parameter-shift gradient descent requiring $2 \times 2p = 40$ circuit executions per step across $N_{\text{shots}} \in \{64, 256, 1024, 4096\}$). All reported means and paired net differences across the manuscript are accompanied by 95% confidence intervals computed via instance-level non-parametric percentile bootstrap (`replicates = 4,000`).

Implementation Details

All hyperparameters of `Echo-MF-2kD` (`Echo-Flat-2kD`) were locked on the $n = 10$ validation set (512 instances) and frozen zero-shot across all test sets, depths, and system sizes. In Stage 1, damped mean-field inference uses $T_{\text{mf}} = 80$, $\alpha_{\text{d}} = 0.5$, and $\beta^\star_{\text{mf}} = 2.0$; deterministic temperature-continuation cluster orientation (`resolve_prior_direction`) perturbs up to $\min(n, 6)$ most uncertain spins (closest to $\pi_i^{\text{mf}} = 0.5$), runs 28 damped updates ($\alpha_{\text{d}} = 0.5$) at each inverse temperature $\beta \in \{2.5, 6.0, 16.0\}$, and performs up to $2n$ zero-temperature single-spin and conflicting-edge swap sweeps. Daubechies Flat-Top synthesis uses extended-precision arithmetic (`mpmath`, $40 + 3k$ decimal digits, construction residuals $< 10^{-10}$), and 1D convex-interval bisection runs up to 60 steps (tolerance 10^{-9}) per zero-free interval to extract $M_{\text{anc}} = 10$ anchors. In the composite adjoint objective, weights are fixed at $\kappa_w = 1.5$, $\lambda_{\text{quad}} = 0.5$, $\tau_{\text{quad}} = 14.0$, $\pi_{\text{safe}} = 0.56$, $\lambda_{\text{inv}} = 1.5$, $\tau_{\text{inv}} = 10.0$, $\delta_{\text{inv}} = 0.08$, $\alpha_E = 1.5$, $\mu_g = 0.005$, and $\mu_\theta = 0.03$. Trust-region box bounds are $g_j \in [\max(-10\pi, g_j^{(0)} - 3.5), \min(10\pi, g_j^{(0)} + 3.5)]$ and $\theta_j \in [\max(-1.40, \theta_j^{(0)} - 0.75), \min(1.40, \theta_j^{(0)} + 0.75)]$ with non-degenerate mixer bound $\theta_{\max} = 1.40 < \pi/2$. Step 1a runs 48 L-BFGS-B steps on $\boldsymbol{g} \in \mathbb{R}^k$; Step 1b runs 64 L-BFGS-B steps on $(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) \in \mathbb{R}^{2k}$, selecting the optimal anchor via $J_{\text{select}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) = E_{\text{prod}}(\boldsymbol{g}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) - 0.25 \cdot \mathbf{1}[\min_{i \in NZ} \pi_i > 0.50] + \frac{0.05}{|NZ|} \sum_{i \in NZ} \ln \pi_i$. Stage-2 full-angle optimization uses bound-constrained L-BFGS-B[47] (`scipy.optimize.minimize(..., method="L-BFGS-B", jac=True)`) with `maxiter = 128`, `maxfun = 2048`, `maxls = 20`, `ftol = 2.220446049250313e-9`, `gtol = 1e-8`, and box bounds $[-10\pi, 10\pi]^p \times [-\pi/2, \pi/2]^p$, verified by dual independent statevector engines (`NumPy/autograd` and `PyTorch complex128`, residuals $< 10^{-14}$). Shot-noise Regime A and Regime B (cosine-annealed Adam learning rate $0.04 \to 0.002$) use deterministic `SeedSequence([0, 1, idx])` and `SeedSequence([0, 2, shots, idx])`; bootstrap CIs use `seed = 0`.

Data Availability

The five-family Ising benchmark datasets (`data/benchmark`), the Maximum Weight Independent Set learning and cross-scale benchmark datasets (`data/mwis`, spanning $n \in \{6, 8, 10, 12, 14\}$ with 5,120 test instances), and all source data CSV files underlying Figures 1–3 and Extended Data Tables 1–2 are publicly available at https://github.com/jollyxenon/Echo-MF-2kD.

Code Availability

All core source code—including the `Echo-MF-2kD` and `Echo-Flat-2kD` SU(2)-adjoint manifold refinement engine (`src/echo/multiscalar.py`), Daubechies maximally flat filter synthesis (`src/echo/core.py`), and deterministic evaluation and plotting scripts—is open-sourced under the MIT License at https://github.com/jollyxenon/Echo-MF-2kD.

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Author Contributions

J.Y. conceived the mathematical theory, designed the `Echo-MF-2kD` algorithm, implemented the software and benchmark suites, performed the numerical experiments, analyzed the data, and wrote the manuscript.

Competing Interests

The author declares no competing interests.

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Extended Data

Extended Data Table 1. Initial and uncapped full-convergence ground-state probabilities for `Echo-Flat-1D`, `Echo-Flat-2kD`, and `TQA` across all five Ising problem families at $n = 11, 12, p = 10$ (50 instances per group, 500 instances total; unit: %). `Echo-Flat-2kD` substantially boosts Stage-1 product-state overlap across all four non-zero-field families and achieves large post-optimization gains on heterogeneous-field `MWIS`, while respecting the theoretical 2^{-n_0} zero-field bound on interior-field-free `Pinned MaxCut`. Error intervals denote 4,000-resample bootstrap 95% CIs; bold values mark the best final probability in each row.

Problem Family	Size n	Echo-Flat-1D Init	Echo-Flat-1D (Top-1)	Echo-Flat-2kD Init	Echo-Flat-2kD (Top-1)	Echo-Flat-2kD (Top-2)	TQA (Top-1)	TQA (Top-2)	Echo-Flat-2kD vs. Echo-Flat-1D (Top-1, pp)	Echo-Flat-2kD vs. TQA (Top-1, pp)
MWIS	11	8.84	$44.64^{+7.07}_{-7.15}$	37.09	$\mathbf{56.69}^{+5.39}_{-5.45}$	$\mathbf{60.19}^{+5.11}_{-5.34}$	$27.88^{+3.40}_{-3.48}$	$29.47^{+3.24}_{-3.31}$	+12.05 ([+6.50, +17.93])	**+28.81** ([+23.52, +34.19])
MWIS	12	3.30	$31.09^{+6.13}_{-5.83}$	22.90	$\mathbf{41.66}^{+4.97}_{-4.95}$	$\mathbf{46.62}^{+4.65}_{-4.94}$	$25.10^{+3.60}_{-3.38}$	$26.37^{+3.54}_{-3.31}$	+10.57 ([+4.96, +16.27])	**+16.56** ([+11.67, +21.45])
Dense Ising	11	7.56	$44.14^{+7.00}_{-6.68}$	36.07	$51.24^{+5.82}_{-5.93}$	$54.68^{+5.60}_{-5.63}$	$\mathbf{58.15}^{+6.04}_{-6.15}$	$\mathbf{59.17}^{+5.87}_{-5.97}$	+7.09 ([+0.67, +13.24])	−6.91 ([−14.25, +0.54])
Dense Ising	12	5.94	$43.89^{+6.23}_{-5.84}$	25.99	$42.55^{+5.45}_{-5.23}$	$45.90^{+4.98}_{-4.55}$	$\mathbf{54.81}^{+5.55}_{-5.55}$	$\mathbf{55.51}^{+5.45}_{-5.51}$	−1.34 ([−7.32, +4.36])	−12.27 ([−18.45, −6.12])
Sparse Ising	11	9.12	$58.62^{+5.97}_{-5.87}$	37.47	$56.27^{+5.52}_{-5.56}$	$61.23^{+4.94}_{-4.86}$	$\mathbf{64.26}^{+5.43}_{-5.80}$	$\mathbf{65.57}^{+5.35}_{-5.61}$	−2.35 ([−9.19, +4.46])	−7.99 ([−15.60, −0.39])
Sparse Ising	12	5.09	$45.36^{+6.04}_{-5.92}$	24.70	$44.75^{+4.81}_{-4.95}$	$48.52^{+5.00}_{-4.66}$	$\mathbf{53.00}^{+5.95}_{-5.95}$	$\mathbf{53.97}^{+5.83}_{-5.82}$	−0.60 ([−7.33, +6.07])	−8.25 ([−15.30, −1.39])
Grid Ising	11	6.96	$53.80^{+5.30}_{-5.12}$	30.17	$53.58^{+4.28}_{-4.08}$	$\mathbf{61.29}^{+3.75}_{-3.66}$	$\mathbf{59.61}^{+5.06}_{-5.38}$	$60.71^{+4.94}_{-5.20}$	−0.21 ([−5.44, +4.93])	−6.03 ([−11.75, −0.37])
Grid Ising	12	5.05	$48.30^{+5.82}_{-5.80}$	28.72	$45.38^{+4.95}_{-5.04}$	$47.81^{+4.54}_{-4.57}$	$\mathbf{58.27}^{+5.63}_{-5.64}$	$\mathbf{59.44}^{+5.60}_{-5.65}$	−2.91 ([−9.07, +2.97])	−12.89 ([−20.64, −5.21])
Pinned MaxCut	11	0.37	$27.23^{+3.61}_{-3.42}$	0.37	$26.09^{+3.75}_{-3.57}$	$29.56^{+3.71}_{-3.39}$	$\mathbf{40.32}^{+4.51}_{-4.42}$	$\mathbf{40.97}^{+4.48}_{-4.38}$	−1.15 ([−3.03, +0.47])	−14.23 ([−17.61, −10.86])
Pinned MaxCut	12	0.20	$26.09^{+3.97}_{-3.36}$	0.20	$24.79^{+4.03}_{-3.56}$	$27.97^{+3.94}_{-3.49}$	$\mathbf{34.83}^{+4.93}_{-4.41}$	$\mathbf{36.15}^{+5.05}_{-4.54}$	−1.30 ([−2.70, +0.11])	−10.04 ([−13.51, −6.37])

Extended Data Table 2. Stage-1 candidate selection hit rates (Regime A) and Stage-2 parameter-shift gradient optimization ground-state probabilities (Regime B, unit: %) on the MWIS center test set ($n = 10, p = 10$, 1,024 instances) under finite projective measurement shot noise. Because `Echo-MF-2kD` executes Stage-1 refinement purely on a classical processor (0 online quantum measurements), it achieves 100% immunity to Stage-1 shot-noise misselection and already reaches $\mathbf{42.20}^{+1.55}_{-1.70}$% in its 0-step initial state ($\mathbf{46.70}^{+1.78}_{-1.90}$% after noiseless recoupling). Error intervals denote 4,000-resample bootstrap 95% CIs; bold values mark the best result in each column.

Shots per Evaluation N_{shots}	Regime A: TQA Hit Rate	Regime A: Echo-MF Hit Rate	Regime B: Echo-MF-2kD (16 / 32 / 64 steps)	Regime B: Echo-MF-Flat (32 / 64 steps)	Regime B: TQA (64 steps, $32 + 2560$)	Echo-MF-2kD (64 steps) vs. TQA (64 steps) Net Gain (pp)
64	51.02%	**100.00%**	$44.03^{+1.72}_{-1.86}$ / $45.60^{+1.78}_{-1.91}$ / $\mathbf{46.77}^{+1.81}_{-1.93}$	$15.62^{+1.62}_{-1.61}$ / $17.63^{+1.72}_{-1.68}$	$18.52^{+0.64}_{-0.63}$	**+28.25** ([+26.32, +30.09])
256	66.13%	**100.00%**	$44.48^{+1.74}_{-1.86}$ / $46.12^{+1.78}_{-1.91}$ / $\mathbf{46.93}^{+1.81}_{-1.93}$	$15.87^{+1.66}_{-1.62}$ / $17.66^{+1.74}_{-1.72}$	$18.93^{+0.64}_{-0.63}$	**+28.00** ([+26.09, +29.84])
1,024	78.20%	**100.00%**	$44.61^{+1.76}_{-1.87}$ / $46.19^{+1.78}_{-1.92}$ / $\mathbf{46.94}^{+1.81}_{-1.92}$	$16.12^{+1.67}_{-1.62}$ / $17.95^{+1.73}_{-1.71}$	$19.03^{+0.65}_{-0.64}$	**+27.91** ([+26.00, +29.76])
4,096	—	**100.00%**	$44.73^{+1.77}_{-1.88}$ / $46.28^{+1.79}_{-1.94}$ / $\mathbf{46.98}^{+1.81}_{-1.93}$	$16.23^{+1.68}_{-1.61}$ / $17.93^{+1.75}_{-1.70}$	$19.11^{+0.65}_{-0.64}$	**+27.87** ([+25.96, +29.71])
∞ (Exact Statevector)	100.00%	**100.00%**	— / — / $\mathbf{46.70}^{+1.78}_{-1.90}$	— / $23.23^{+1.83}_{-1.92}$	$21.94^{+0.68}_{-0.68}$	**+24.76** ([+22.87, +26.62])